

GOOGLE CYBERSECURITY CERTIFICATE

Social Engineering

Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate · Study Guide

A USB-baiting exercise — analyzing what an attacker could learn and do with a dropped USB drive found in a hospital parking lot, and the technical, operational, and managerial controls that mitigate the risk.

Track	Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate
Course	Assets, Threats, and Vulnerabilities
Scenario	USB baiting / "parking lot drop"
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1 Parking Lot USB Exercise

An employee, Jorge, finds a USB drive in the parking lot of the hospital where he works and plugs it into his computer out of curiosity. The exercise analyzes the attack from the finder's, the attacker's, and the defender's perspective.

Contents on the device

Some documents appear to contain personal information Jorge wouldn't want made public. The work files include other people's PII, plus information about the hospital's operations.

Attacker mindset

The timesheets and work files give an attacker intelligence about who Jorge works with. Either the personal or the work information could be used to craft a convincing pretext — for example, a phishing email designed to look like it comes from a coworker or a relative.

KEY INSIGHT This is the core mechanic of a USB-baiting attack: the payload isn't necessarily malware on the drive itself — it can just as easily be the information on it, used later to make a phishing attempt far more convincing.

Mitigating controls

Control type	Example
Managerial	Employee awareness training on what to do with a found/unknown USB drive
Operational	Routine antivirus scans as a standard operating procedure
Technical	Disable AutoPlay/AutoRun on company machines so a USB drive can't auto-execute code when plugged in

2 Quick Reference



Social engineering — quick reference

USB baiting defenses:

Managerial -> security awareness training ("don't plug in unknown USB drives")

Operational -> routine AV scanning procedures

Technical -> disable AutoPlay/AutoRun; endpoint device control policies